

Minjae Seo

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EDUCATION

University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy

June 2027

Master of Arts in Public Policy, Certificate in Research Methods

GPA: 3.7/4.0

Selected Coursework: Applied Econometrics I–III (PhD), Advanced Microeconomics I–II (PhD), Game Theory (PhD), Real Analysis

University of California, Berkeley

Dec 2024

Bachelor of Arts in Statistics

GPA: 3.85/4.0

Selected Coursework: Modern Statistical Prediction & Machine Learning, Principles & Techniques of Data Science, Causal Inference, Optimization Models in Engineering

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, R, Stata, C, MATLAB, SAS

Toolkit: pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, matplotlib, fixest, rdrobust, dplyr, ggplot2, Git, Quarto, LaTeX, AWS, WRDS Cloud, Tableau, Power BI, React, ETL

Methods: A/B and multi-arm testing, RCT design, regression, DiD, triple-difference, RD, IV, synthetic control, PSM/IPW/AIPW, double ML, partial identification, SMOTE & cost-sensitive learning, drift detection

EXPERIENCE

Research Analyst Intern, World Bank, Washington, DC

Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

- Analyzed two nationwide tax-compliance experiments for Pakistan’s Federal Board of Revenue (88,229 companies across 8 message arms; 102,130 licensed engineers across 6), showing that messaging lifted filing in both but revenue in only one: over 90% of the corporate filings it caused were empty, while engineers filed with real liability (+1.3pp, +PKR 455).
- Overtured a program-wide conclusion that had generalized the corporate result to all taxpayers, and pulled a headline +81% result that conditioned on a post-treatment outcome, so government counterparts were briefed only on effects the design could support.
- Built the Lumina evidence platform: a verified review of 30 youth-employment RCTs across 8 categories, plus a Python pipeline that computes every dashboard figure from a validated JSON layer, so each number traces to a source row.

Research Assistant, Booth School of Business, University of Chicago

Jan 2026 – Jun 2026

- Delivered a 2.38B-row (4.90 TiB) U.S. job-postings dataset on WRDS Cloud using chunked state-by-year SQL with automated checkpoint/resume, so a pull that exceeds memory and wall-clock limits completes unattended.
- Consolidated 899 Excel sources (448,119 citation rows, 1920–2000) into a ranked 14,500-journal database using fuzzy name normalization and three-pass QC, cross-validated against an independent Python build to catch silent merge errors.

AI Intern, YCX, Remote

Mar 2025 – May 2025

- Shipped an AI system to production that runs know-your-business compliance checks analysts had done by hand, combining LLM agents (Groq API) with targeted web scraping.
- Grew the number of companies the system can screen by 40%, to 300+, by adding a modular pipeline that pulls from open-web sources and corporate filings and returns schema-conformant JSON.

Quantitative Research Intern, Global Key Advisors

Jul 2024 – Mar 2025

- Engineered the reusable Python extraction and ROI-tracking pipelines behind the team’s strategy backtests, merging SEC Form 4, CRSP, and Refinitiv across the Fama–French 48 industries.
- Tested whether insider-disclosure rules leave exploitable alpha, building event-time abnormal-return signals around filings and backtesting industry portfolios against Fama–French factors.

PROJECTS

Community-College Transfer Earnings Gap (R, NLSY97 microdata)

Sep 2025 – May 2026

- Measured how much less community-college transfer students earn than students who start at a four-year school: \$7,770 less per year ($p = 0.048$, $N = 2,306$). Confirmed the estimate across five estimators and against government administrative data.
- Showed that a widely cited explanation for the gap was a statistical artifact — it came from comparing different groups of people, not from the factor being credited. Holding the comparison group fixed shrank the effect from 27.5% to 4.5%.

AI Exposure and Labor Demand (Python, Revelio Labs + Compustat)

Mar 2026 – Jun 2026

- Assembled a 14.5M-cell panel linking Revelio Labs job postings to Compustat financials (2018–2025) and ran a triple-difference across occupation AI exposure, firm size, and the pre/post-ChatGPT split.
- Estimated sharp declines in AI-exposed job postings at both small (-0.211 , SE 0.033) and large (-0.146 , SE 0.026) firms, but the difference between them was not distinguishable from zero ($+0.065$, $p = 0.14$) — reported as a null, not a headline.

TEACHING & LEADERSHIP

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Mathematical Foundations of ML, University of Chicago

Sep 2025 – Dec 2025

- Taught weekly recitations for 20+ master’s students with Python/NumPy demos on SVD, Gram–Schmidt, and least squares.

Head of Research, Undergraduate Economics Association, UC Berkeley

Jan 2024 – Mar 2025

- Led biweekly research workshops for 30+ undergraduates in OLS, IV, DiD, and RDD with R/Stata.

Competitor, Econometrics Game, University of Chicago

Mar 2024

- Competed as one of four in a 48-hour empirical research competition; presented to a panel including a Nobel Laureate in Economics.